English Language Tests

Your English Proficiency Test. Your Gateway to Global Education.

Planning to study abroad? Demonstrating your English-language proficiency is an important part of the international education journey. Depending on your destination, university, course and visa requirements, you may need to submit an approved English-language test score as part of your application.

At **Shreya Namankan**, we help students understand their English-language requirements and identify the test that is appropriate for their chosen university and destination. From selecting the right examination to understanding score requirements and preparing for your application, our team helps you navigate the process with clarity.

Which English Language Test Do You Need?

There is no single English test that is suitable for every student. Universities and institutions may accept different examinations, and requirements can vary by country, university, course and level of study.

Some of the most widely recognised English-language tests include:

IELTS

IELTS (International English Language Testing System) is one of the world's most widely recognised English-language examinations.

IELTS Academic is commonly used for higher-education applications and evaluates four core skills:

- Listening
- Reading
- Writing
- Speaking

Students may need to achieve a specific overall band score as well as minimum scores in individual sections, depending on their university and course.

PTE Academic

PTE Academic (Pearson Test of English Academic) is a computer-based English-language test designed to assess academic English proficiency.

The examination evaluates speaking, writing, reading and listening skills. PTE is accepted by many universities and institutions around the world, although acceptance and required scores can vary between courses and institutions.

TOEFL iBT

TOEFL iBT (Test of English as a Foreign Language) is an internationally recognised English-language examination used by universities and other institutions.

The test measures the ability to use and understand English in an academic environment and assesses reading, listening, speaking and writing skills.

Duolingo English Test

The **Duolingo English Test (DET)** is an online English proficiency examination that can be taken remotely.

It is accepted by many universities and offers students a convenient testing option. However, acceptance differs between institutions and programmes, so students should always verify the requirements of their chosen university before booking the test.

Cambridge English Qualifications

Cambridge English qualifications include examinations such as **C1 Advanced** and **C2 Proficiency**.

These qualifications assess advanced English-language skills and are recognised by universities, employers and organisations in various countries.

OET

Occupational English Test (OET) is designed specifically for healthcare professionals.

It assesses English communication in healthcare-related contexts and may be relevant to doctors, nurses and other healthcare professionals pursuing education, professional registration or employment overseas.

How Do You Choose the Right English Test?

Choosing an English-language test should be based on your **specific university and course requirements**, rather than simply choosing the most popular examination.

Before registering for a test, you should consider:

Your destination: Different countries and institutions may have different English-language requirements.

Your university: Check which English tests your university accepts.

Your course: Some programmes may have higher or additional English-language requirements.

Your required score: Universities may specify both an overall score and minimum scores in individual components.

Your application deadline: Allow enough time for preparation, testing and receiving your results before your application deadline.

Your visa or professional requirements: In some cases, visa or professional registration requirements may differ from university admission requirements.

At Shreya Namankan, we help you understand these requirements before you commit to a particular test.

English Test Requirements

English-language requirements can vary significantly. A university may accept several different tests while requiring different minimum scores for each. Some courses, particularly those involving communication-intensive subjects or professional accreditation, may also have additional requirements.

For this reason, **there is no universal “required IELTS score” or English score for studying abroad.**

Your requirement depends on factors such as:

- University
- Course
- Degree level
- Country
- Intake
- Applicant background
- Visa requirements
- Professional or regulatory requirements

Our team can help you identify the relevant requirement for your chosen programme and guide you through the next steps.

Need Help Preparing for Your English Test?

Preparing for an English-language examination is not only about achieving a high score. It is about understanding the examination format, knowing what your university requires and preparing strategically around your application timeline.

We can help you understand:

✓ Which test may be suitable for your application
✓ What score your university requires
✓ Individual section requirements
✓ Test format and assessment structure
✓ When you should take your examination
✓ How your English test fits into your overall application timeline

Whether you are preparing for **IELTS, PTE, TOEFL, Duolingo or another accepted English qualification**, our team can help you understand the process.

Start Your Study Abroad Journey With Confidence

Your English-language test is one part of a much bigger journey.

From **university selection and applications to scholarships, education loans, visas and accommodation**, Shreya Namankan provides end-to-end guidance for students planning to study abroad.

Not sure which English test you need?

Tell us your **destination, university and course**, and our team can help you understand the relevant English-language requirement.

Speak to a Shreya Namankan Counsellor

Get personalised guidance for your study-abroad journey.

SUBSECTION (IELTS)

🎁 BONUS: HOW TO PREPARE FOR IELTS IN 30 DAYS

Need to take IELTS soon? Start here.

If you already have a decent level of English, you do not necessarily need months and months of IELTS preparation.

What you do need is a proper plan.

A lot of students spend weeks watching IELTS videos, learning hundreds of new words and doing practice tests without actually understanding why they are losing marks.

This guide is meant to keep things simple.

Take a test. Find your weak areas. Work on them. Practise again.

Here is how you can structure your 30 days.

DAY 1: TAKE A FULL MOCK TEST

Before you start preparing, find out where you actually stand.

Take a complete IELTS Academic mock test under proper exam conditions.

Do not pause the listening section. Do not use Google. Keep to the time limit. Complete the writing tasks and record yourself for the speaking section if you can.

Once you have your result, look at each section separately.

You may find that:

Your Reading is good, but you are running out of time.

Your Listening score is fine, but you keep losing marks because of spelling.

Your Writing has good ideas, but your grammar or structure needs work.

Your Speaking is fluent, but you repeat the same words or give very short answers.

This is what you need to work on during the next 30 days.

DAYS 2 TO 7: UNDERSTAND THE EXAM

The first week is about getting comfortable with the IELTS format.

Reading

Do not worry about completing full tests every day.

Start with individual passages and learn how the different question types work.

Practise:

• True / False / Not Given
• Matching Headings
• Multiple Choice
• Sentence Completion
• Summary Completion
• Matching Information

Whenever you get an answer wrong, go back to the passage and find the exact part that contains the answer.

Then ask yourself why you got it wrong.

That is much more useful than simply checking the answer and moving on.

Listening

Do a section at a time and pay attention to what causes you to lose marks.

Sometimes the problem is not understanding English. You may simply miss the answer because you are not following the conversation closely enough.

Also watch out for:

• Spelling
• Numbers
• Dates
• Names
• Singular and plural answers
• The word limit

Writing

Get familiar with both tasks.

For Task 1, practise describing the information clearly rather than trying to mention every single number on the page.

For Task 2, focus on answering the question properly and developing your ideas.

A simple, well-organised essay is much better than an essay full of complicated sentences that are difficult to understand.

Speaking

Start recording yourself.

Pick a Part 2 topic, set a timer and speak for two minutes.

Then listen to the recording.

You will quickly notice things that you may not realise while speaking, such as long pauses, repeated words or unfinished sentences.

DAYS 8 TO 14: WORK ON YOUR WEAK AREAS

Now you know what is costing you marks.

This is where your preparation should become more targeted.

If your Reading score is already strong, you do not need to spend three hours every day doing Reading.

Spend that time on the section where you actually need improvement.

A good daily routine

30 minutes: Listening
45 minutes: Reading
45 minutes: Writing
20 minutes: Speaking
15 minutes: Review mistakes

You can adjust this depending on your own scores.

The important thing is to spend more time on your weaker areas.

DON'T TRY TO LEARN 1,000 NEW WORDS

One of the biggest mistakes students make is trying to memorise huge vocabulary lists.

You do not need to use complicated words just to sound impressive.

Instead, learn useful words and phrases that you can actually use correctly.

For example, if you are preparing an essay about education, learn phrases such as:

access to education

higher education

tuition fees

career opportunities

academic performance

financial pressure

Then practise using them in your own sentences.

The aim is not to make your English sound complicated.

The aim is to make it clear, accurate and natural.

DAYS 15 TO 21: START WORKING WITH THE CLOCK

By the third week, you should start practising under proper time limits.

Reading

You have 60 minutes for the Reading test.

Start getting used to working at roughly 20 minutes per passage.

If one question is taking too long, move on and come back to it later.

Do not let one difficult question take away the time you need for five easier ones.

Listening

Do the test once without stopping.

Then spend time checking your mistakes.

Ask yourself why you missed each answer.

That review is where you actually learn from the test.

Writing

Start practising within the actual time limits.

Try to keep roughly:

20 minutes for Task 1

40 minutes for Task 2

Do not spend so long trying to make Task 1 perfect that you have to rush Task 2.

Speaking

Do not memorise complete answers.

Instead, practise developing your thoughts.

When you get a question, think about:

Why?

What is an example?

What happened in your experience?

What are the advantages or disadvantages?

This will help you speak naturally instead of sounding like you have memorised an answer from a book.

DAYS 22 TO 27: FULL MOCK TESTS

Now start doing complete tests.

But there is one rule:

Do not just check your score and move on.

After every mock test, write down what went wrong.

For example:

Reading: 32/40

Instead of simply writing the score, write:

> I lost marks mainly on Matching Headings and spent too long on Passage 3.

Or:

> I understood the passage but couldn't find the answers quickly enough.

That gives you something specific to work on.

Your score tells you where you are.

Your mistakes tell you what to fix.

DAYS 28 AND 29: REVISE YOUR COMMON MISTAKES

By now you should have a list of mistakes you keep making.

Go through it.

Look at:

- Grammar mistakes
- Spelling mistakes
- Reading question types you struggle with
- Listening mistakes
- Writing errors
- Vocabulary you regularly misuse
- Speaking habits such as repeated words or long pauses

Do not try to learn everything again.

Focus on the things that have repeatedly caused you problems.

DAY 30: KEEP IT SIMPLE

The day before your test is not the time to panic.

Do a light revision.

Check your test details and make sure you know where you need to go and what time you need to be there.

If you are taking the test online, check your equipment and surroundings.

Get enough sleep.

You have already done the preparation.

Now you need to be able to use it.

A SIMPLE 2-HOUR DAILY PLAN

If you can study for around two hours a day, try this:

30 minutes
Listening

30 minutes
Reading

40 minutes
Writing

20 minutes
Speaking

If you have more time, spend it reviewing your mistakes rather than endlessly taking another practice test.

If you only have one hour, alternate your focus.

Day 1: Reading + Writing

Day 2: Listening + Speaking

Day 3: Reading + Writing

And repeat.

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5 THINGS WE WANT YOU TO REMEMBER

1. Take a mock test before you start.

You need to know your starting point.

2. Do not just practise. Review.

A practice test is useful only if you understand your mistakes.

3. Do not memorise essays.

Learn how to structure and develop your own answers.

4. Do not force complicated vocabulary.

Correct and natural English is more useful than difficult words you are not comfortable using.

5. Practise with a timer.

Knowing the answers is not enough. You also need to be able to complete the test within the given time.

CAN YOU REALLY PREPARE FOR IELTS IN 30 DAYS?

It depends on your current level of English and the score you need.

If you already communicate comfortably in English, 30 days of focused preparation can give you enough time to understand the exam, work on your weak areas and get used to the format.

If you are starting with a much lower level of English, you may need longer.

There is no genuine shortcut to improving your English.

But there is a difference between studying for IELTS and simply studying English.

If your English is already good, your preparation should focus on understanding the test, improving your technique and avoiding the mistakes that are costing you marks.

Start with a mock test today.

Find out where you stand.

Then use the next 30 days properly.

Planning to study abroad?

IELTS is only one part of the process.

At Shreya Namankan, we help students with university selection, applications, scholarships, education loans, visas and accommodation.

Our guidance is free for students.

Not sure which English test your university accepts? Speak to our team before booking your test.